

Causey for school districts

January 2027 assisted pilot

Causey

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Audience: district administrators, school administrators, and program coordinators

Product: Causey (<https://app.causey.dev>)

Horizon: what the district will use during the January 2027 assisted pilot

This is not a snapshot of the live site today, a self-serve signup, or a finished procurement package.

This document describes what Causey *will* give a participating school district by January 2027. Features that are still being finished are written in future tense on purpose. Independent clubs and teams will keep a separate self-serve workspace; this brief is district and school only.

One place for every competition

Causey will be the district's coordination layer for **every scholastic competition type** the schools run, not a chess-only tool with other types mentioned in passing.

By the January pilot, a district will use the *same* school and district workflow for:

- Chess
- Speech and debate
- STEM (including mathematics and science-fair style events)
- Arts (visual arts, music, and theatre)
- Writing

Families will search every type from one zip search. Coaches will roster, invite, host or travel, take attendance, and record results on the same screens no matter which type the event is. The district

office will read school-level totals across all of those types, not a separate chess report and a pile of spreadsheets for everything else.

Public listing coverage will still be denser in some types than others. Chess will remain the broadest public index. Speech and debate, STEM, arts, and writing will have real official listings, and those indexes will still be incomplete. The district's own school and district-hosted events will sit next to those listings for every type. Families will still confirm fees, eligibility, and paid entry on the organizer's site when the event is not hosted on Causey.

Causey will not give the central office a copy of any student's browsing. Reports will stay aggregate: how many students, how many events, who still needs an RSVP, who went, who showed up.

How a district will start

Setup will stay hands-on. Causey will create the district record with the district, check that each participating school is real, and hand each school to the administrator the district names. There will be no instant district signup and no public school directory on Causey.

1. Causey will provision the district after written approval.
2. Each school will be created, checked, and claimed by a named administrator. No shared passwords.
3. Staff will invite their own people with join links and claim links (including CSV for larger groups).
4. Coaches will run school events and district-wide events across every competition type above.
5. Families will RSVP and finish organizer registration where the event still uses an outside site.
6. The district office will read totals, a calendar of school and district events, and a scoped activity feed.

Anyone will still be able to search public listings on Causey without an account. The district pilot is the school-side coordination on top of that search.

To talk through a pilot: <https://app.causey.dev/districts>.

What people in the district will be able to do

District office

The district will hold a district account that oversees connected schools, not a single club page pretending to be a district.

- Add schools and see each school's setup status (administrator assigned, ownership handed off, roster started).
- Follow one next action on the district overview instead of a dump of every setting.
- Invite district staff without giving them student-by-student browsing access.
- Open a calendar of upcoming **school-hosted and district-hosted** events, with the host named on each row, across every competition type.
- Host a district-wide competition when the district is the real host, or leave hosting with a school.
- On a district-hosted event, invite students from connected school rosters, or every connected school at once. Districts will not keep a student roster of their own.
- Publish announcements that reach connected schools in one district-office action, or stay on district staff only.
- Open Reports for school-level totals: students on roster, upcoming events, pending RSVPs, going, and attendance. District-hosted events will stay separate from school-hosted events so a district tournament is not counted as if every school ran it.
- Export those totals as CSV.
- Read a scoped Activity feed for school creates, staff invitations, verification and ownership changes, announcements, and competition status changes on that district only.

School administrators

- Receive a named invitation and claim a school account.
- Take ownership of the school workspace after claim.
- Invite coaches, assistants, students, and families.
- Import staff or students from CSV, with a row-by-row error list when a file fails.

- Manage school settings, verification, and the people list.
- See school-hosted competitions and school reporting for every competition type the school runs.

Coaches

- Run a roster and groups (for invites and the day-of list).
- Create competitions as drafts, preview them, then publish. Chess, speech and debate, STEM, arts, writing, or a custom type the school needs.
- Choose who can see an event: public, district-only, school-only, or invite-only.
- Invite students, collect RSVPs, and see who still needs to finish organizer registration on the tournament's own site.
- Record attendance, then division, place, or award. Blanks will mean not recorded.
- Post short announcements. Copy can be whatever the event needs ("Bring boards Saturday," "Bring tubs," "Bring posters").
- Edit or cancel a hosted event after it is published.

Parents

- Link to a child account and use a family desk: which child still needs an RSVP, or still needs to finish organizer registration, across every competition type.
- Get alerts for invites, deadlines, schedule changes, cancellations, and recorded results. By January those alerts will also go out by email, not only in the app.

Students

- Search chess, speech and debate, STEM, arts, and writing events by zip and distance without creating an account.
- Create an account to save events, RSVP, keep a plan, and join a school with a join link.

Causey staff (not the district)

- Create and verify the district.
- Review public school-created events before they appear in the public directory.
- Help with corrections when a school record needs more detail.

January pilot feature list

Feature	What the district will have	January pilot
Search for every type	Zip and distance search across chess, speech and debate, STEM, arts, and writing. Fees, venues, and coverage will still vary by type; families will confirm with the organizer.	Yes, coverage still incomplete
Same workflow, every type	Roster, invite, host or travel, RSVP, attendance, results, and district totals will work for every competition type above, not chess alone.	Yes
District → school structure	One district over many schools. Causey-assisted setup.	Yes
Role-based access	District, school, coach, assistant, parent, and student each see the work meant for them.	Yes
Claim-link provisioning	Email or copyable invite; CSV import/export; reissue. No shared passwords.	Yes
Rosters and groups	School roster and groups for invites and attendance.	Yes
School and district events	Draft → preview → publish. Public events go through Causey review. District inventory includes child-school hosts. District-hosted manage invites connected-school rosters.	Yes
Event audiences	Public, district-only, school-only, or invite-only.	Yes
RSVP and attendance	Going / not going, attendance on the day, season view.	Yes
Organizer registration tracking	Families mark when they finished the external registration. Causey will not replace that site.	Yes

Feature	What the district will have	January pilot
Recorded results	Place or award after attendance. Export when a board asks.	Yes
Family follow-through	Parent inbox of named child actions across every type.	Yes
Announcements	Short notes from district or school staff. District overview can post once to every connected school.	Yes
Alerts and email	Invites, deadlines, 7-day and 1-day reminders, changes, cancel, recorded results. Email will run at school volume for the pilot cohort.	Yes for the pilot cohort
Aggregate reports + CSV	School-level counts, not student browsing. School-hosted vs. district-hosted kept separate.	Yes
Activity	District-scoped feed of setup and competition changes. Not a raw audit table.	Yes
Privacy and terms pages	Public disclosures of what student data is stored. Formal certification is a separate legal track (see below).	Published; legal review continues

What the January pilot will not include

These will stay out of the pilot on purpose. Do not read them as “coming next week.”

- Instant district signup, or a public directory of schools.
- In-app entry fees, payments, or registration that replaces the organizer’s site.
- Coach–parent messaging threads.
- Pairings, ballots, clocks, or dues.
- A complete public index of every speech, debate, STEM, arts, or writing event in the country. The district will run every type; the public directories will still be incomplete.

- Central-office access to what any student searched, saved, or browsed.
- A finished price, contract, SLA, or FERPA / state-privacy *certification*. Before a paid student rollout, Causey and the district will still settle price, support, privacy, how long data is kept, and security. The pilot will run under a written agreement and data terms; certification is not the same thing as those terms existing.

How a season will run

For a school or a coach, the season will be the same four jobs for every competition type:

1. **Roster.** A join link or a CSV. Groups for invites and the day-of list.
2. **Travel or host.** Mark the school as going to a public event, or publish a school or district event here.
3. **Attendance.** Who showed up, including travel events the school attended.
4. **Results.** Place or award. Export when a board asks.

For the district office, the same season will look like:

1. **Provision.** The district and its schools are set up with Causey, one at a time.
2. **School tournaments.** Coaches run the roster and the day at each school, in every type the school offers.
3. **District-wide.** One event, every connected school, when that is the real host.
4. **District office.** School-level totals. Never a copy of any student's browsing.